



USER'S GUIDE

SeventhSlide

Worship Presentation Software

VERSION 1.1 · FIRST EDITION

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About this guide. This manual explains everything you need to run SeventhSlide for a service: from preparing songs ahead of time to controlling the screens live. You do not need any prior experience with presentation software. Read Chapter 1 first; after that, each chapter stands on its own.

Throughout the guide, the names of on-screen buttons and panels are set in **SMALL CAPITALS**, and keys you press look like this.

Getting Started

A contemporary worship service requires an effective way to display lyrics, scripture, images, and videos across projectors, reinforcement displays, foldback displays, live stream graphics, and more. Finding a software to manage all these sources and destinations, while also producing a tasteful output, is difficult. Some offerings exist, but they tend to be either needlessly expensive subscriptions or are feature starved, rendering them obsolete. SeventhSlide aims to meet all these needs for free while remaining unintimidating for the end user by relying on one intuitive control window.

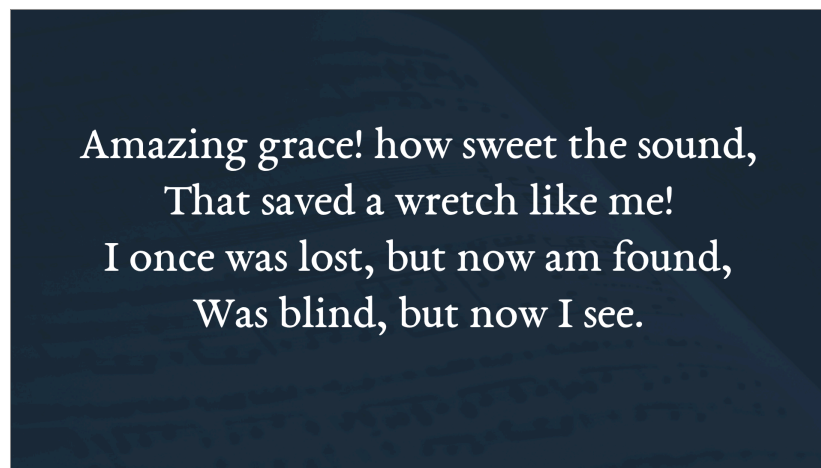


FIGURE 1.1. An example of what your congregation could see: song lines on the main screen.

In SeventhSlide, you can prepare ahead of time by collecting the songs, scripture references, and announcements you will need into a *service*, an ordered list like a printed order of worship. When the worship service begins, you click through that list and SeventhSlide sends each line to the screens. In cases which require more spontaneity, such as a youth group meeting or camping event, SeventhSlide is also capable of loading media on the fly. Either approach is ready to use depending on your needs.

1.1 Starting the program

1. Double-click the **SEVENTHSLIDE** icon. After a moment the control window opens by itself.

2. Connect your projector or second screen as you normally would in the operating system (extend the desktop, do not mirror it).
3. You are ready. Everything below happens inside the one window.

NOTE

SeventhSlide also serves its control window to a web browser. On another device on the same network, open `http://this-computer:49777/admin`, using the host computer's network address. This is handy if you prefer to operate from a tablet or other separate device on the same network.

1.2 The control window at a glance

The window is divided into three columns. You will spend almost all of your time moving between them, so it is worth learning what each one does.

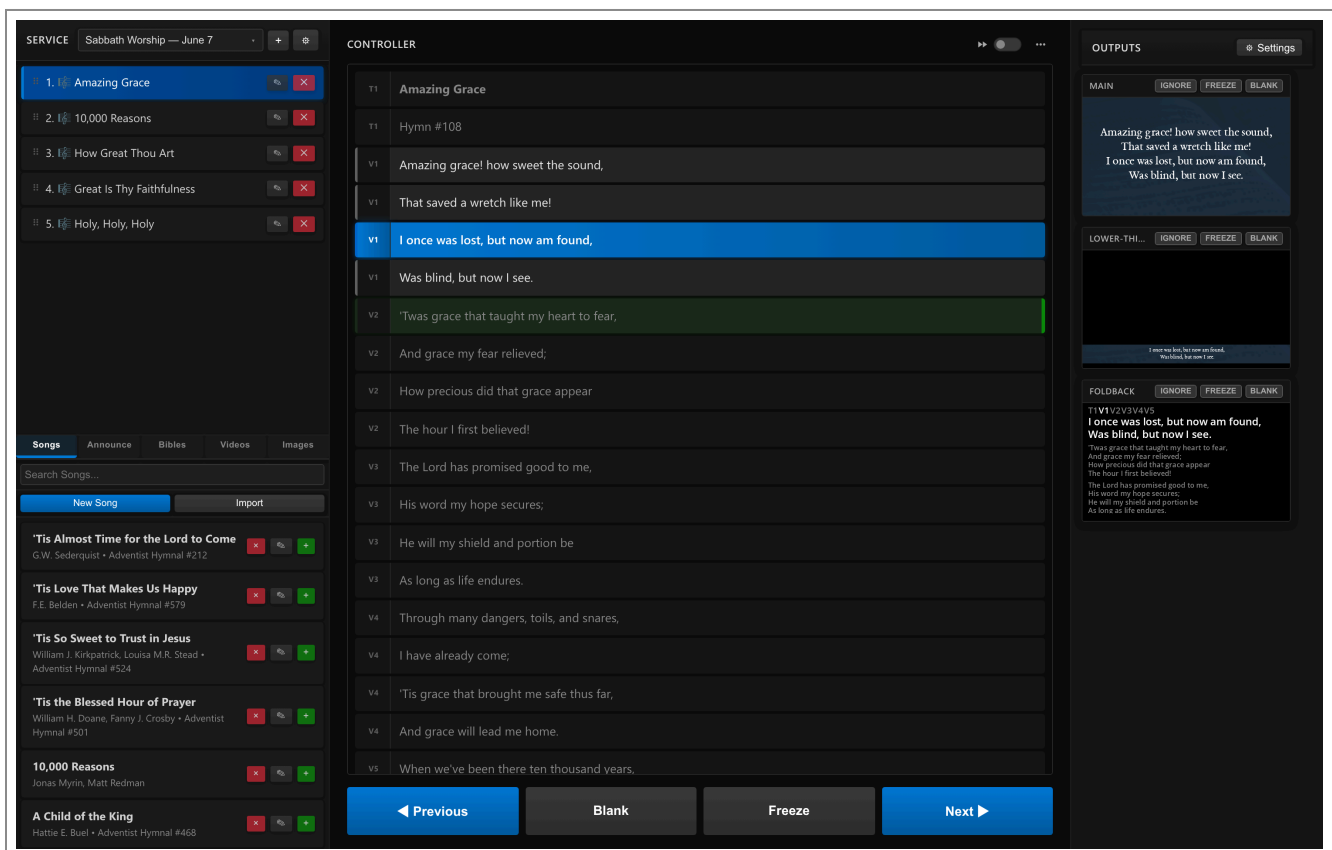


FIGURE 1.2. The control window. *Left:* your service and the library of material. *Center:* the Controller, where you go live. *Right:* a live preview of every screen.

The left column: Service & Library

The top half holds the **SERVICE**: the running order for this service. The bottom half is the **LIBRARY**, your whole collection of songs, Bibles, announcements, images and videos, arranged on tabs.

The center column: Controller

When you pick something from the service, its slides appear here. This is where you move from line to line during the service, and where the **BLANK** and **FREEZE** buttons live.

The right column: Outputs

A small live picture of each screen you are driving (for example a main projector and a stage monitor), so you can always see exactly what your congregation sees.

TIP

The picture on the right updates the instant you change anything. If you are ever unsure what is on the screens, glance at the right column. It never lies.

Building a Service

A *service* is simply your order of worship: the songs, readings and notices for one service, listed in the order you will use them. You build it in the top-left panel, usually before the service begins.

2.1 Choosing or creating a service

At the top of the left column is the **SERVICE** menu. Click the wide button (it shows the current service name) to open the list.

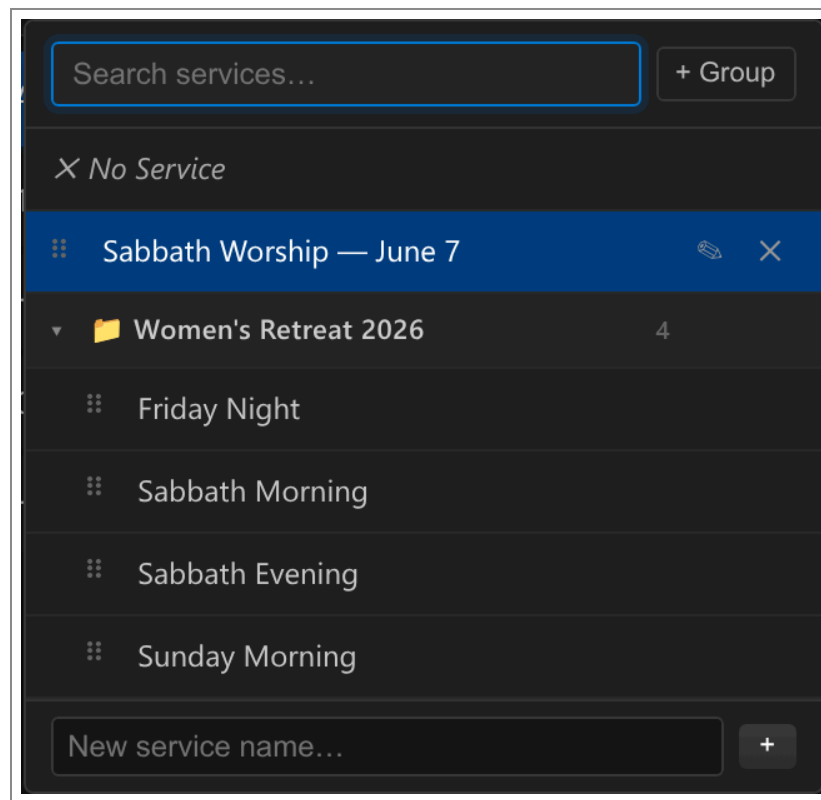


FIGURE 2.1. The service menu. Existing services are listed; type a name at the bottom and press  to start a new one.

- To **open** a service, click its name.
- To **create** one, type a name in the box at the bottom (for example, “Sabbath Worship - June 7”) and click .
- To **rename** or **delete** a service, use the pencil and  icons that appear on its row.

- **No SERVICE** clears the running order without deleting anything.
- **+ GROUP** makes a folder, so you can keep the several services of a weekend (Friday Night, Sabbath Morning, and so on) together.

2.2 Adding items to the service

Everything you place in a service comes from the Library in the lower-left panel. Each item in the Library has a small green  button. Clicking it adds that item to the end of the current service.

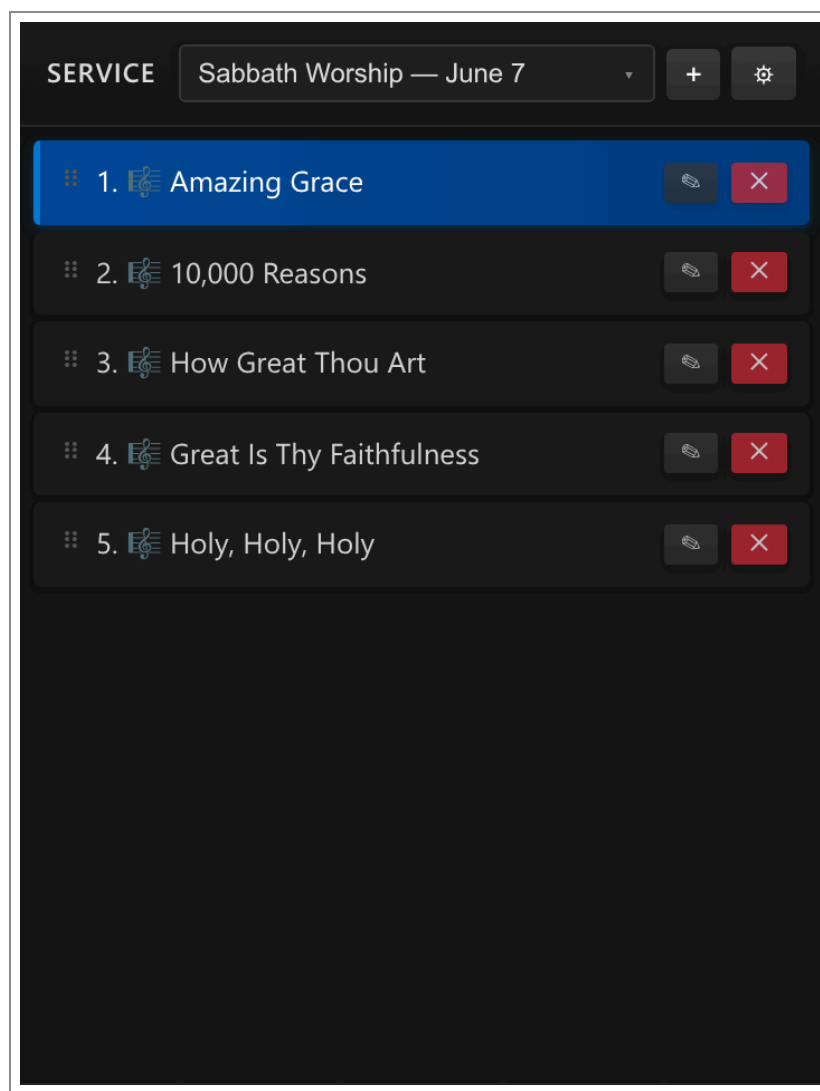


FIGURE 2.2. A service in progress. Items run top to bottom; drag the handle to reorder, or use the red  to remove one.

You can add songs, Bible passages, announcements, images and videos this way. Chapters 3 through 7 explain each kind of material in turn.

Reordering and removing

- **Reorder:** drag an item up or down by its dotted handle.
- **Remove:** click the red  on its row. This removes it from the service only; the original stays safe in your Library.

Folders and dividers

The  button beside the service name opens a small menu:

- **ADD FOLDER:** groups a set of images together inside the running order.
- **ADD DIVIDER:** inserts a labelled separator (for example “Sermon” or “Offering”) to mark the sections of your service.

NOTE

The gear  beside the service name opens **SERVICE OPTIONS**, where you can choose a different look for this particular service. That is covered in Chapter 9.

The Song Library

The Library is your permanent collection. Songs you add here stay available for every future service, so most of your preparation is done once and then simply reused.

3.1 Finding a song

Open the **Songs** tab in the lower-left panel. Type any part of a title or author into the search box and the list narrows as you type.

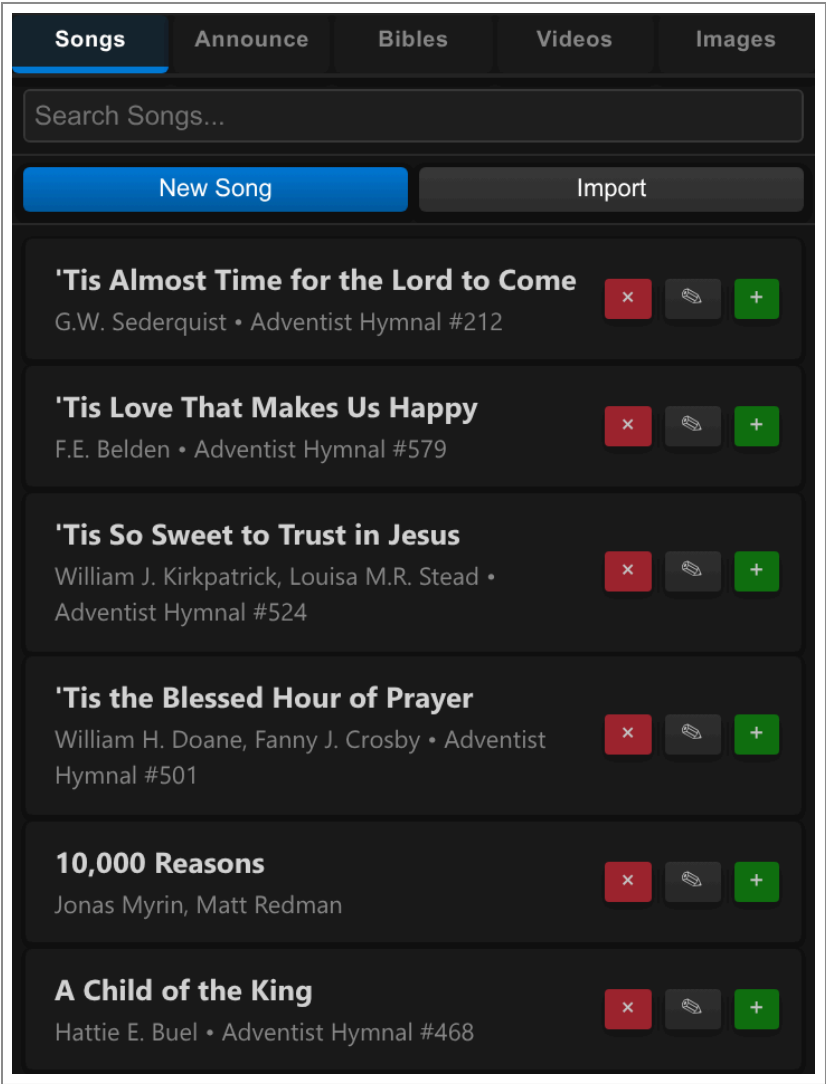


FIGURE 3.1. The Song Library. The green  adds a song to your service; the pencil edits it; the red  removes it from the Library.

3.2 Adding a new song

1. Click **NEW SONG**. The song editor opens.
2. Fill in the **TITLE** and one or more **AUTHORS**.
3. If you wish, add the **SONGBOOK** name and entry number (for hymns), and the copyright, CCLI number and musical key.
4. Type or paste the words in the **LYRICS** area, then click **SAVE**.

Edit Song

Title
Amazing Grace

Authors
John Newton ✕
[+ Add Author](#)

Songbook Name
Adventist Hymnal

Entry #
108

Copyright
©2000 Good Music Co.

CCLI Song #
7201044

Key
A

☐ Display copyright on output

Lyrics Guided Raw XML

No verse order set — plays verses as written

Title 1 + 🔗 ✕

Amazing Grace
Hymn #108

Verse 1 + 🔗 ✕

Amazing grace! how sweet the sound,
That saved a wretch like me!
I once was lost, but now am found,
Was blind, but now I see.

Verse 2 + 🔗 ✕

'Twas grace that taught my heart to fear,
And grace my fear relieved;
How precious did that grace appear
The hour I first believed!

Verse 3 + 🔗 ✕

The Lord has promised good to me,
His word my hope secures;
He will my shield and portion be
As long as life endures.

Verse 4 + 🔗 ✕

Through many dangers, toils, and snares,
I have already come;
'Tis grace that brought me safe thus far,

FIGURE 3.2. The song editor. In **GUIDED** mode each part of the song (title, verses, chorus) is its own labelled block.

Guided and Raw modes

The lyrics area has two modes, chosen by the toggle at its top-right:

Guided

The recommended way. Each section of the song (Verse 1, Chorus, and so on) is a separate labelled box. Use the green to add a section. SeventhSlide breaks long sections into screen-sized slides for you.

Raw XML

For advanced users importing or hand-editing the underlying song file.

3.3 Importing existing songs

If you already have songs in the common **.xml** song format (such as OpenLyrics files exported from other programs), click **IMPORT**, then choose one or more files. They are added to your Library at once.

TIP

To add several songs to a service quickly, tick the box on each song row to select them, then use **ADD TO SERVICE** in the bar that appears at the bottom of the list.

IMPORTANT

The red on a Library row deletes the song from your collection permanently. To take a song out of the running order without deleting it, use the red in the *Service* panel instead (Chapter 2).

CHAPTER 4

Going Live: The Controller

The Controller, in the center of the window, is where you work during the service. Whatever you do here appears on the screens straight away, so this is the chapter to be comfortable with before your first service.

4.1 Putting an item on screen

Click any item in the **SERVICE** panel. Its contents open in the Controller as a list of lines, one for each thing that can be shown on screen. This list is sometimes called the *slide map*.

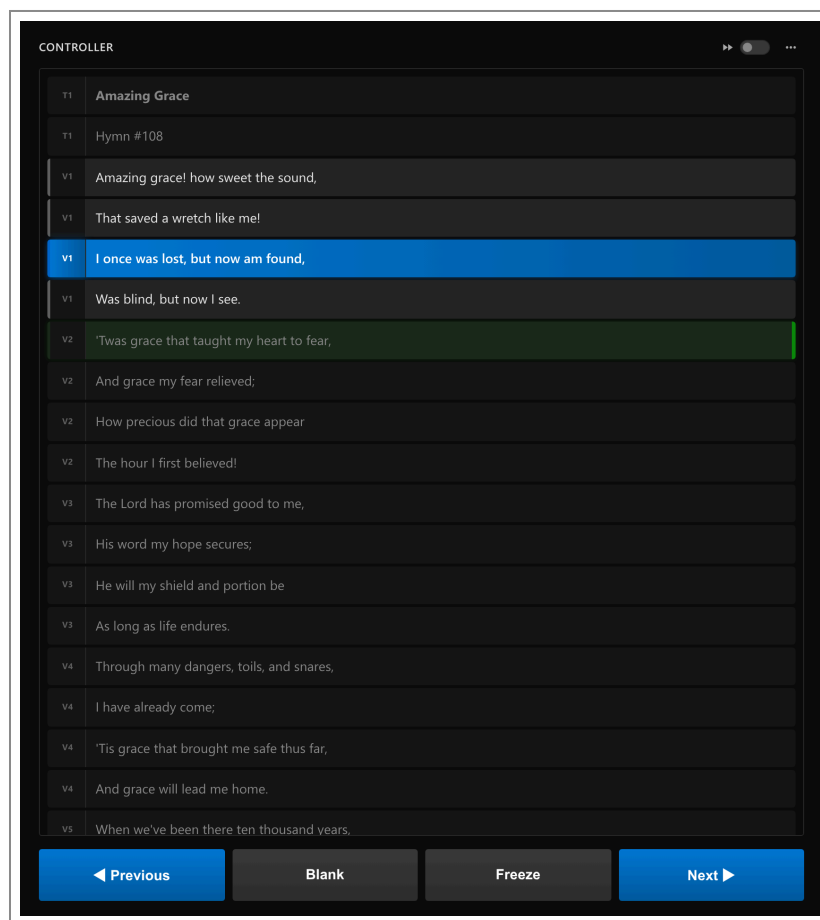


FIGURE 4.1. The Controller. The line currently on screen is highlighted in green. Click any line to send it live immediately.

The small labels down the left edge tell you what each line is:

T
the title slide.

V1, V2...
verses, in order.

C
a chorus.

B
a bridge.

4.2 Moving from line to line

There are three ways to advance, and you may mix them freely:

- **Click** any line in the slide map to jump straight to it.
- Use the **PREVIOUS** and **NEXT** buttons beneath the slide map.
- Press the  /  / **Page Down** keys to go forward, and  /  / **Page Up** to go back.



FIGURE 4.2. *The live controls sit beneath the slide map.*

TIP

A remote presentation clicker that sends Page Up and Page Down will drive SeventhSlide perfectly. This is handy for presenters wishing to control their own slides.

4.3 Blank and Freeze

Two buttons let you take command of the screens at any moment:

BLANK

Hides the words and shows a plain background (or black). Click it again to bring the words back. Use it during prayer, or whenever the screen should rest.

FREEZE

Holds the current picture on the screens while you get the next item ready behind the scenes. Your congregation keeps seeing the frozen frame; nothing you do in the Controller reaches the

screens until you unfreeze.

These two buttons act on *all* of your screens at once. (To blank or freeze a single screen on its own, see Chapter 8.)

SHORTCUT

Press **F** to freeze or unfreeze every screen, and **B** to blank or unblank, without reaching for the mouse. Press the same key again to return to normal. (These keys are ignored while you are typing in a box, so they won't get in your way.)

4.4 Advancing automatically

For an unattended slideshow (a pre-service loop of announcements, say), turn on **AUTO-ADVANCE** using the play-shaped switch at the top of the Controller. The gear beside it opens the timing options.

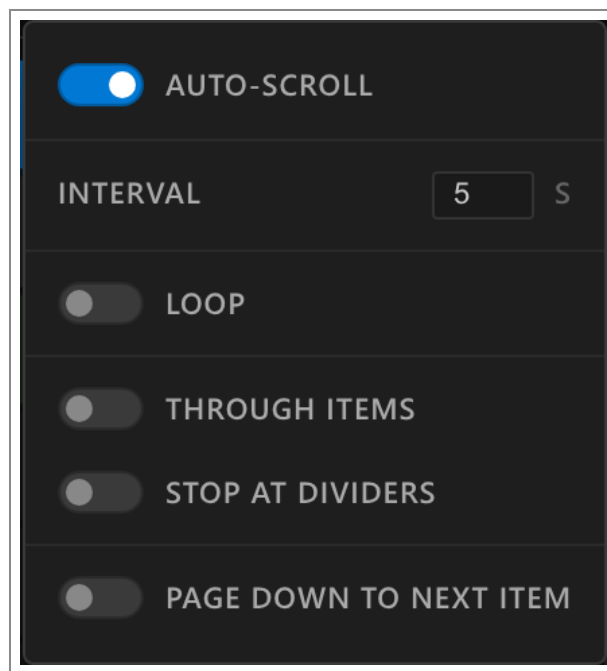


FIGURE 4.3. Auto-advance options.

Interval

how many seconds each slide stays on screen.

Loop

return to the beginning when the end is reached.

Through items

continue past the end of one item into the next.

Stop at dividers

pause when a divider is reached.

Auto-scroll

keep the live line in view as the map advances.

Scripture

SeventhSlide can display Bible passages directly, without your having to type them out. Choose the translation, the book, the chapter and the range of verses, and the passage is ready to project.

5.1 Selecting a passage

Open the **BIBLES** tab in the lower-left panel.

The screenshot shows a web application interface for selecting Bible passages. At the top, there are five tabs: 'Songs', 'Announce', 'Bibles' (which is highlighted), 'Videos', and 'Images'. Below the tabs, there are four main input sections. The first section is for the translation, with a dropdown menu set to 'New King James Version' and buttons for '+', a pencil icon, and a red 'x' button. The second section is for the book, with a dropdown menu set to 'Genesis' and a dropdown for the chapter set to '1'. The third section is for the verse range, with 'Verse:' followed by a dropdown set to '1', the word 'to', another dropdown set to '1', a blue 'Go' button, and a '+' button. Below these input sections, the selected passage is displayed in a list of six items, each with a number and text. The items are: 1. 'In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth.', 2. 'The earth was without form, and void; and darkness was on the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters.', 3. 'Then God said, "Let there be light"; and there was light.', 4. 'And God saw the light, that it was good; and God divided the light from the darkness.', 5. 'God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. So the evening and the morning were the first day.', 6. 'Then God said, "Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters."'.

FIGURE 5.1. *The Scripture picker. Choose a translation, book and chapter, then set the verse range.*

1. Choose a **translation** from the top drop-down.
2. Choose a **book**, then a **chapter**.
3. Set the **verse range**: a starting verse, "to", and an ending verse.
4. Click **Go** to put the passage on screen at once, or the to add it to your service for later.

The verses of the chosen chapter are listed below, so you can read them before deciding on a range.

Adding more translations

Use the small  beside the translation drop-down to import a Bible in **.xml** format. The pencil  renames a translation and the red  removes one.

NOTE

Once a passage is in your service, it behaves like any other item: select it in the Controller and step through the verses with **NEXT** and **PREVIOUS**, just as you would a song.

Announcements

Announcements are short notices (a welcome, a reminder, a theme for the day) that you compose once and reuse. Each one can follow a chosen layout so your notices look consistent.

6.1 Creating an announcement

Open the **ANNOUNCE** tab in the lower-left panel and click + **NEW ANNOUNCEMENT**. Give it a title and its text, choose a layout, and save.

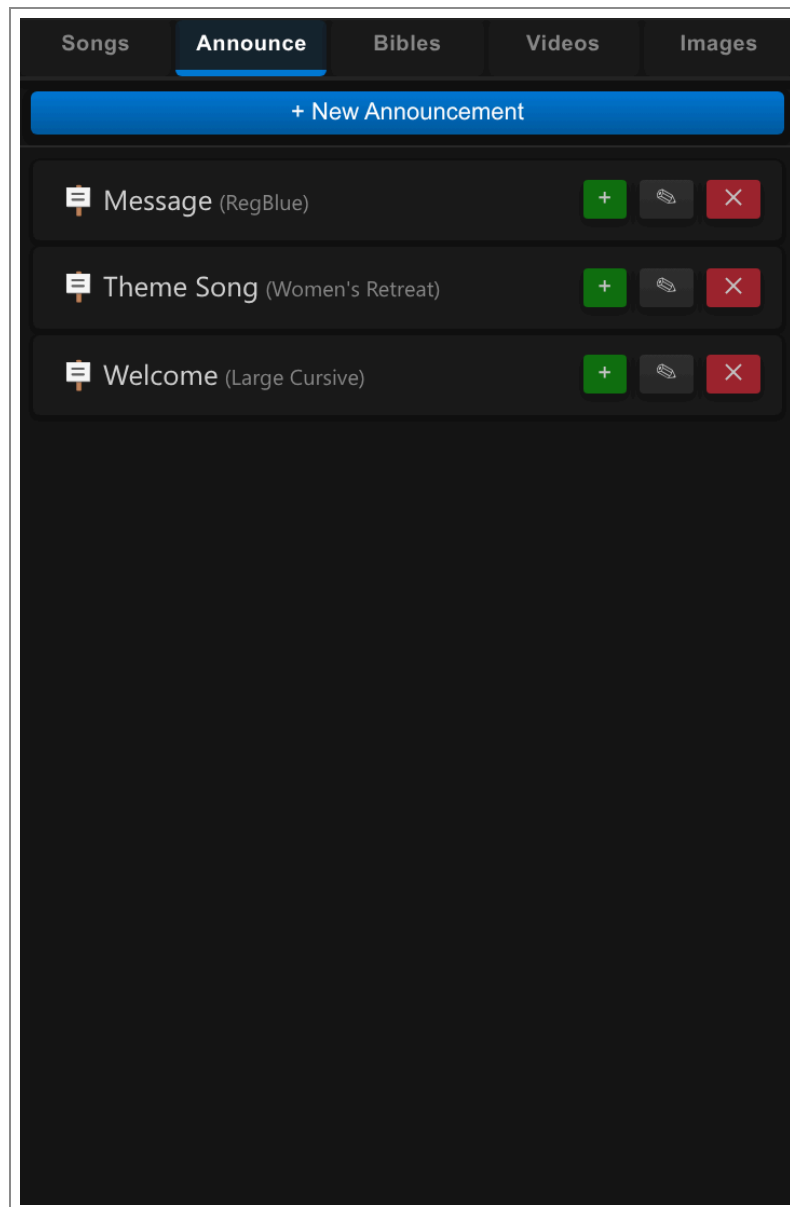


FIGURE 6.1. *The announcement list. The name of each one's layout is shown in brackets.*

Each announcement row works like every other Library item:

- green  adds it to the current service;
- pencil edits its wording or layout;
- red  deletes it from the Library.

NOTE

The *layout* of an announcement, where the text sits and how it looks, is defined by a template. You can create and adjust these templates from a screen's settings; see Chapter 9.

Images & Video

Photographs and video clips are added to your Library and can then be used in a service just like songs. Common service uses include slide presentations imported from PowerPoint, Keynote, LibreOffice Impress, or other software that supports image export; Mission Spotlight videos; and the general display of graphics and visual media.

7.1 Images

Open the **IMAGES** tab. Click **UPLOAD IMAGES** to bring pictures in from your computer; you may select several at once.

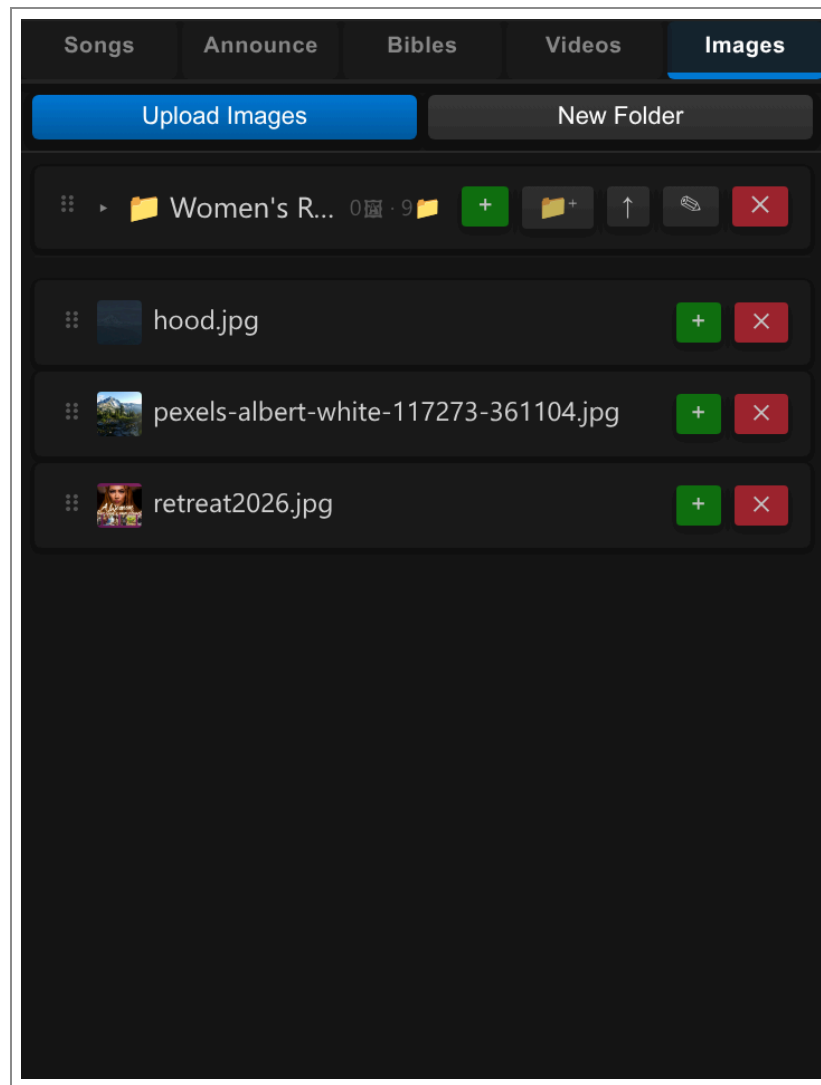


FIGURE 7.1. *The Images tab. Use **NEW FOLDER** to keep a set of related pictures together.*

- green  adds the picture to your service;
- red  deletes it from the Library.
- **NEW FOLDER** groups pictures (for example, a set of photos for one item) so they travel together.

7.2 Video

Open the **VIDEOS** tab and click **UPLOAD VIDEO**. Once a video is in your service and selected in the Controller, play controls appear:

- **PLAY** and **PAUSE** to control playback;
- **BLANK** and **FREEZE**, just as for any other item.

TIP

For a looping welcome slideshow, add your images (or a folder of them) to the service, then turn on **AUTO-ADVANCE** with **LOOP** switched on (Chapter 4).

Screens & Outputs

An *output* is one destination for your presentation: a projector, a television, a stage monitor, or a feed for the livestream. SeventhSlide can drive several at the same time, each with its own look, and the right-hand column shows you a live picture of every one.

8.1 The Outputs panel

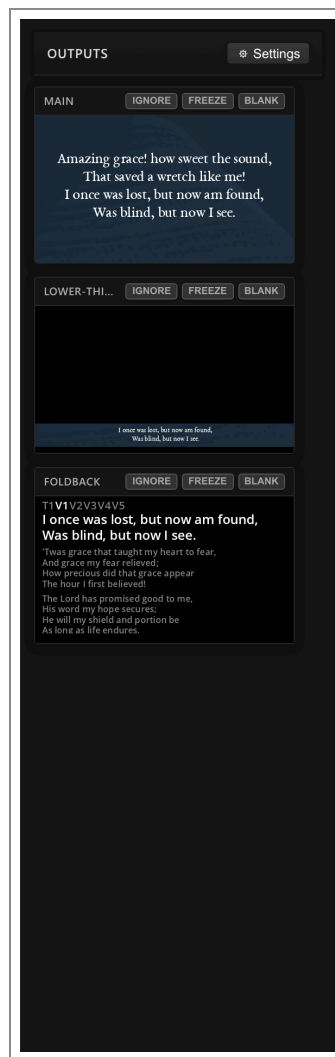


FIGURE 8.1. Each output shows a live thumbnail and three buttons of its own.

Across the top of each output's thumbnail are three buttons that affect *that screen alone*:

IGNORE

The controller stops accounting for this output and does not display any text. Useful when an output is not in use and dividing lines to it is unnecessary.

FREEZE

Holds this one screen's current frame.

BLANK

Hides this one screen's content.

Remember the difference: the **BLANK** and **FREEZE** buttons in the center Controller act on *every* screen; these act on a single screen.

8.2 Sending an output to a monitor

Beneath each output's thumbnail is a small strip for placing that output on a physical monitor, such as your projector or a stage television.

1. Choose a monitor from the drop-down. Each connected display is listed, and the line below the drop-down shows the one you picked together with its size (for example, **3840×2160**).
2. Click **SEND**. The output fills that monitor at once, and the button changes to **STOP**.
3. Click **STOP** to take the output back off the monitor.

SeventhSlide remembers these choices, so the same outputs return to the same monitors the next time you start the program. If a monitor is unplugged its output simply waits, and reappears when the monitor is connected again.

Sound on a screen

Beside the **SEND** button is a small speaker button. It controls whether the sound of a video plays through *that monitor*:

- a loud-speaker  means the sound is on;
- a crossed-out speaker  means that screen is muted.

Because the local computer will likely drive computer audio for the main speaker mix in the church/venue, it is important to manage which outputs drive sound out of the local computer. Leaving all outputs enabled might mean duplicate audio output, highly unideal for live use.

Because of this, muting a screen here affects only this computer's own output; a web browser or browser source watching the same output is left playing as before.

NOTE

This strip appears only in the SeventhSlide desktop program, which is the part that can place windows on particular monitors. When you operate from a web browser instead (see Chapter 1), the screens are driven by whichever computer the browser tab is open on.

8.3 Adding and editing outputs

Click  **SETTINGS** at the top of the right column. The list of outputs appears, where you can reorder them, edit them, delete them, or click + **ADD OUTPUT** to create a new one.

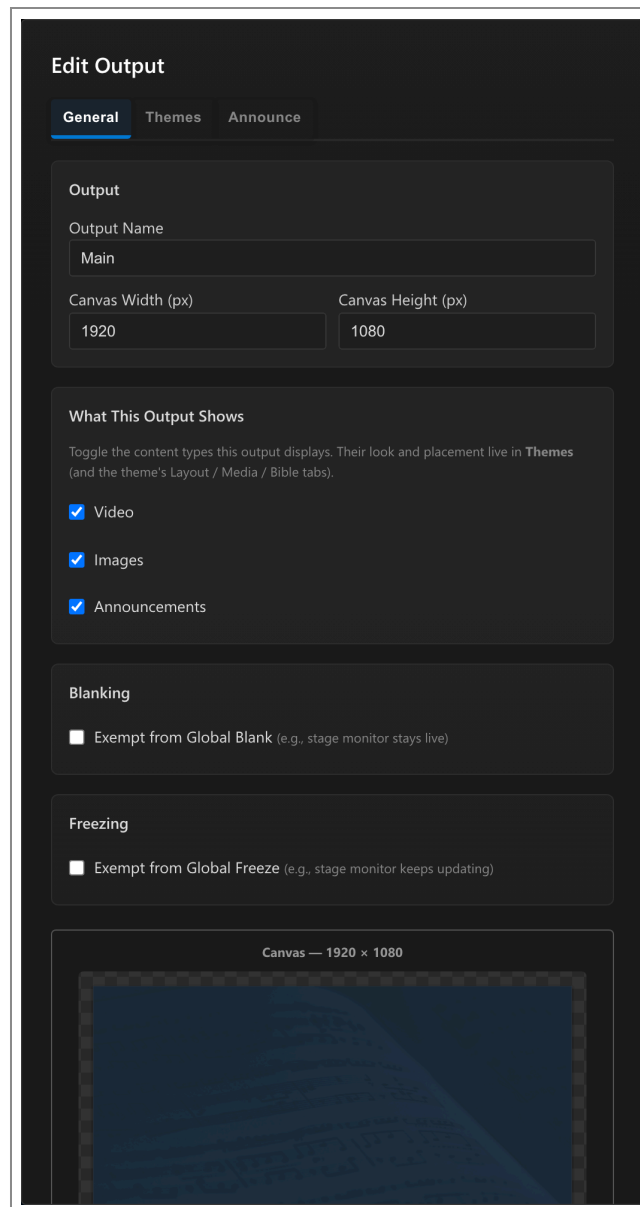


FIGURE 8.2. *An output's GENERAL tab: its name, its canvas size, and which kinds of content it shows.*

The **GENERAL** tab holds the settings that belong to the screen itself:

Output Name

a label such as "Main", "Lower-Thirds", or "Foldback".

Canvas Width & Height

the pixel size of the screen, usually **1920×1080** for a modern projector or television.

What this output shows

tick which content types (video, images, announcements) appear on this screen.

Exempt from Global Blank / Freeze

keep this screen live even when you press the central Blank or Freeze; ideal for a stage monitor that the musicians must always be able to read.

NOTE

How each output *looks* (its fonts, colors, background and the position of the words) is not set here. That lives in *themes*, the subject of the next chapter.

Themes & Appearance

A *theme* is a saved look. By keeping appearance separate from content, SeventhSlide lets you design a style once and then apply it to any song, reading or service, and change it everywhere at the press of a button.

There are two kinds of theme, and they combine:

Text themes

Everything *except* the background: the font, its size, where the words sit, the colors, and how slides change.

Background themes

Just the backdrop: a color, or an image.

9.1 Where themes live

Open an output (⚙ **SETTINGS** → **EDIT**) and choose the **T**H**E**M**E**S tab.

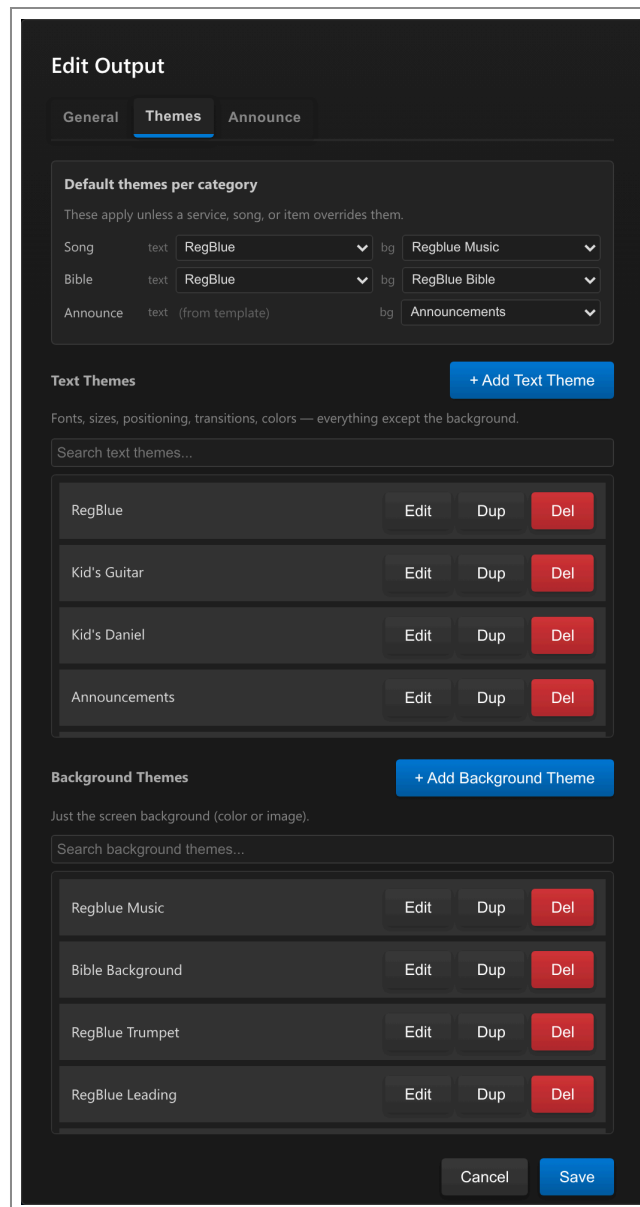


FIGURE 9.1. The *THEMES* tab. The box at the top sets which theme is used by default for songs, Scripture and announcements.

The panel at the top, **DEFAULT THEMES PER CATEGORY**, sets which theme is used for each kind of content unless something overrides it. Below that are your lists of text themes and background themes; each has **EDIT**, **DUP** (duplicate) and **DEL** buttons, and + **ADD** buttons to create new ones.

9.2 Editing a text theme

Click **EDIT** on a text theme to open its settings, which are arranged on tabs. A live **CANVAS PREVIEW** at the foot of the dialog shows your changes as you make them.

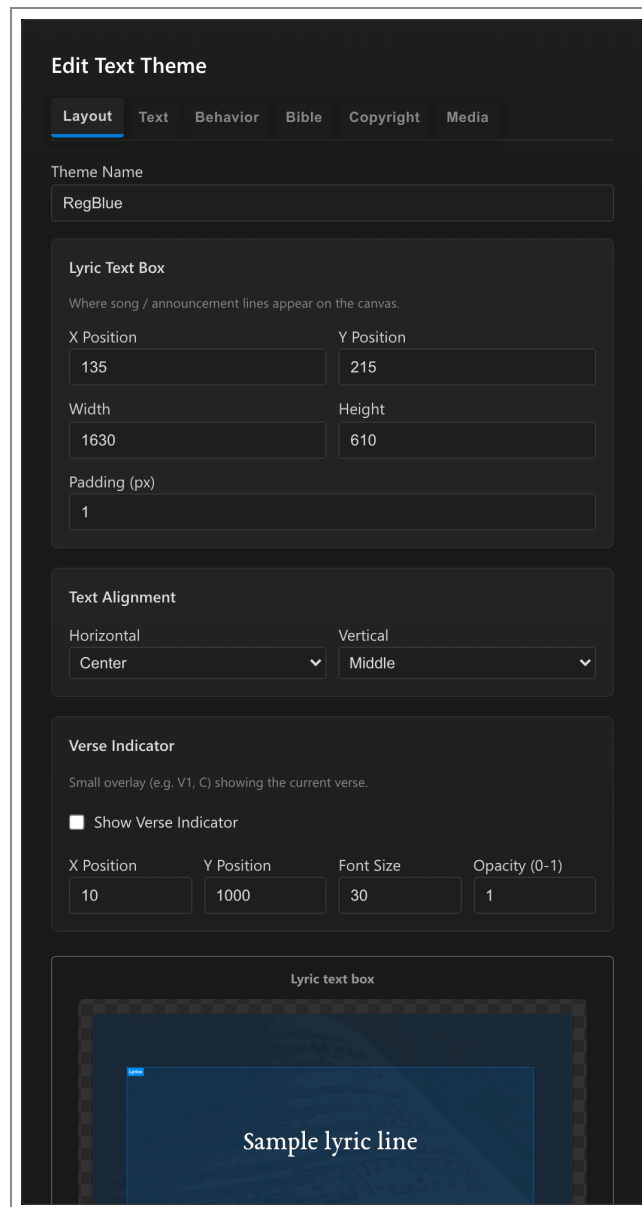


FIGURE 9.2. The *LAYOUT* tab, with the live canvas preview below it.

Layout

the position and size of the text box, the alignment of the words, and an optional small verse indicator.

Text

the font family and size, and the colors of the words.

Behavior

how slides transition: fades, fluid slides, and how many lines to show at once.

Bible

separate styling for Scripture: where the reference and the verse text appear, and whether to show verse numbers.

Copyright

the placement of the copyright / CCLI line.

Media

the area used by video and images.

Edit Text Theme

Layout **Text** Behavior Bible Copyright Media

Theme Name
RegBlue

Font

Font Family: EB Garamond Font Size (px): 110

Colors

Active Line Color: [Color Picker] Other Lines Color: [Color Picker]

Active Line Size (0 = same): 0 Text Opacity (0-1): 1

Options

☐ Show Chords

Lyric text style

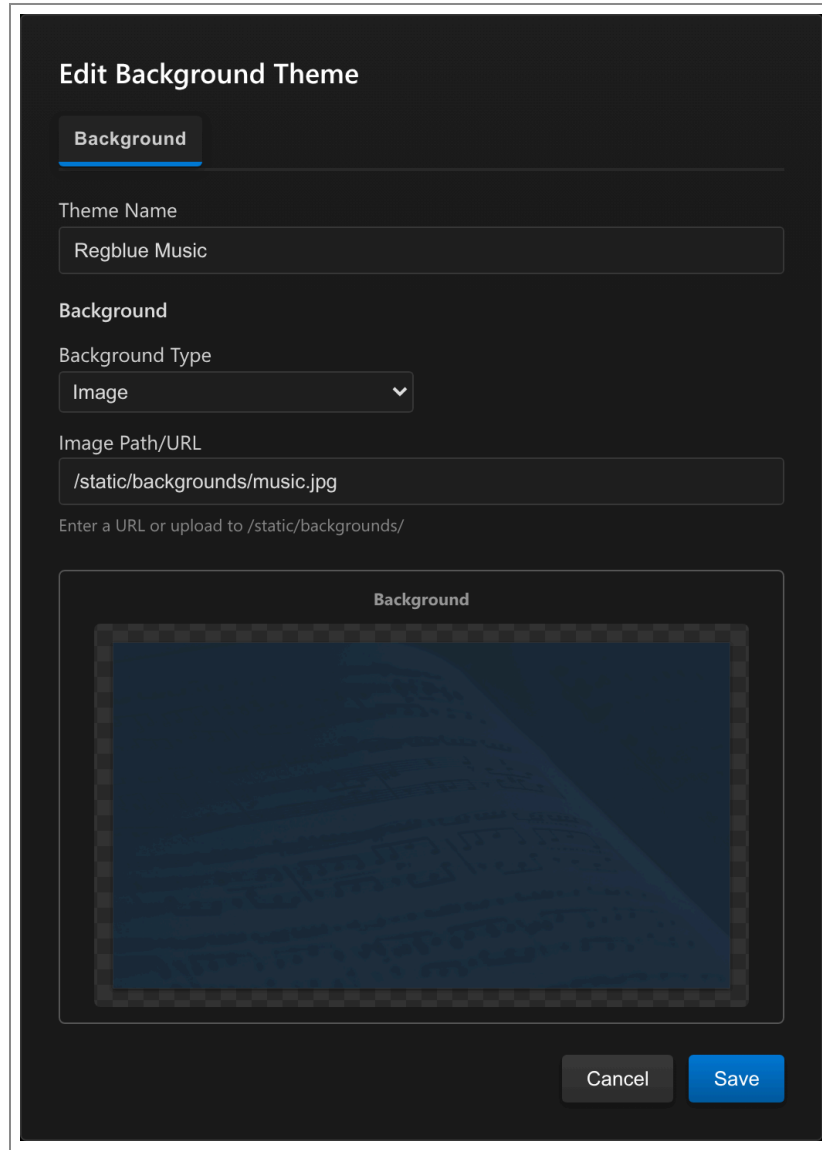
Previous line
Active line
Next line

Cancel Save

FIGURE 9.3. The *TEXT* tab controls font and color.

9.3 Editing a background theme

A background theme has a single **BACKGROUND** tab: choose a solid color, or pick an image to fill the screen behind the words.



The screenshot shows a dark-themed web interface for editing a background theme. At the top, the title "Edit Background Theme" is displayed. Below it, a tab labeled "Background" is selected. The form contains the following elements:

- Theme Name:** A text input field containing "Regblue Music".
- Background:** A section header.
- Background Type:** A dropdown menu with "Image" selected.
- Image Path/URL:** A text input field containing "/static/backgrounds/music.jpg".
- Preview:** A rectangular area labeled "Background" showing a dark blue, textured image of a book cover.
- Buttons:** "Cancel" and "Save" buttons at the bottom right.

FIGURE 9.4. The *BACKGROUND* tab of a background theme.

9.4 A different look for one service

Sometimes a single event needs its own styling (a special evangelistic series, perhaps). Open the ⚙ gear beside the service name to reach **SERVICE OPTIONS**, and choose which theme each output should use for *this service only*. Other services are untouched.

Service Options

Per-output themes for the selected service

Main	Text	(Output Default) ▼	Bg	(Output Default) ▼
Lower-Thirds	Text	(Output Default) ▼	Bg	(Output Default) ▼
Foldback	Text	(Output Default) ▼	Bg	(Output Default) ▼

Close Save

FIGURE 9.5. *Service Options: per-screen themes that apply to the selected service alone.*

TIP

Different screens can wear different themes at the same time. The example used throughout this guide drives a full-screen *Main* output, a *Lower-Thirds* caption bar for the livestream, and a plain *Foldback* monitor for the platform presenters.

I once was lost, but now am found,
Was blind, but now I see.

FIGURE 9.6. *One theme, one purpose: a Lower-Thirds output shows the words as a caption band for the camera feed.*

Program Settings

A few settings apply to the program as a whole. You will normally set these once, when you first install SeventhSlide, and rarely touch them again.

Click ⚙ **SETTINGS** at the top of the right-hand column to open the settings dialog. (This is the same dialog that lists your outputs, from Chapter 8.)

Settings

General Settings

CCLI License Number

e.g. 123456

Your church's CCLI license number for song copyright compliance.

☒ **Bundle local fonts with outputs**

Copies host font files to output clients so typography matches across computers.

Admin Preview Video

Still Frame (recommended) ▼

Controls how video appears in the small admin preview tiles. "Still Frame" shows a paused frame with minimal CPU use.

Save

Outputs

Main (1920x1080)	↑ ↓	Edit	Del
Lower-Thirds (1920x1080)	↑ ↓	Edit	Del
Foldback (1920x1080)	↑ ↓	Edit	Del

+ Add Output

Close

FIGURE 10.1. The Settings dialog. General options sit at the top; your outputs are listed below.

CCLI License Number

Your organization's copyright-reporting number. When set, it is printed on the screen alongside a song's copyright line.

Bundle local fonts with outputs

Copies the fonts you use to the screens, so that type looks identical even when an output is shown on a different computer. Leave this on unless you have a reason not to.

Admin Preview Video

Controls how video appears in the small preview thumbnails on the right. **STILL FRAME** is recommended: it shows a paused frame and uses very little of the computer's power.

Click **SAVE** to keep your changes, then **CLOSE**.

Quick Reference

A summary to keep beside the operator's seat.

11.1 Keys

KEY	ACTION
→ ↓ Page Down	Next line / slide
← ↑ Page Up	Previous line / slide
<i>Click a line</i>	Send that line to the screens at once
F	Freeze or unfreeze all screens
B	Blank or unblank all screens
Esc	Close the current dialog

11.2 The three columns

COLUMN	HOLDS
Left	The Service (running order) above; the Library of songs, Bibles, announcements, images and video below.
Center	The Controller , the slide map you click through live, with Blank and Freeze.
Right	Outputs , a live picture of every screen, each with Ignore, Freeze and Blank.

11.3 Live controls

CONTROL	EFFECT
Blank (center)	Hide content on <i>all</i> screens. Press again to restore.

CONTROL	EFFECT
Freeze (center)	Hold the current frame on <i>all</i> screens while you prepare ahead.
Ignore / Freeze / Blank (a thumbnail)	The same, but for that <i>one</i> screen only.
Send / Stop (a thumbnail)	Place that output fullscreen on a chosen monitor, or take it back. Desktop program only.
Speaker (a thumbnail)	Mute or unmute a video's sound on that monitor, without affecting other devices.
Auto-advance	Step through slides on a timer (the play switch atop the Controller).

11.4 Before a service: a short checklist

1. Open or create the service for today.
2. Add the songs, readings, announcements and media you need, in order.
3. Confirm the projector or screen is connected and extended.
4. Check the right-hand column shows the correct picture on each output.
5. Select the first item, and you are ready to begin.